

BOARD EVOLUTION, 2016–2026

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Purpose

The 2026 board is the result of earned institutional maturation. This record prevents present governance from being projected backward onto a smaller company whose exposures, capital, and operating complexity were different. Historical evidence—appointments, minutes, approvals, charters, and committee records—must reflect the authority system then in force.

2016–2018 — founder board

Daniel, Priya Raman, and Jon Bell form the board. Daniel serves as CEO and Chair. Governance is founder-dominated because the business is a small services-first company. Priya supplies product and technical-substrate judgment; Jon supplies recurrence and commercial challenge; Daniel integrates the enterprise. The later independent-chair and committee system does not yet exist.

2019 — first independent capital voice

Hendrik “Harry” van der Velde joins as the first substantial independent capital/industrial director. His agricultural and commodity-cycle formation introduces a long-memory question: can the company and its commitments survive the cycle? His presence begins independent challenge without displacing founder operating authority.

2020 — scientific and technical depth

Dr. Lilia Maratovna Galiullina joins. Her applied-mathematics and scientific-computing formation adds independent technical depth and an insistence that computation remain accountable to physical reality. Her appointment precedes the full formalization that follows institutional financing.

2021 — growth financing and repeatability

Harrison Vale Partners' approximately \$48 million growth financing brings Evan Mercer to the board. The investment follows the Crossing-era product breakthrough; it does not rewrite the Crossing as investor rescue. Mercer introduces disciplined attention to repeatable deployment, software economics, margin quality, product focus, reliability/security investment, and the services/product boundary.

2022 — industrial capital and control discipline

Wolf Ridge Holdings' approximately \$135 million financing brings Marianne Voss and the long-duration physical-asset/cycle perspective. Thomas “Tom” Calder joins independently with public-company CFO, reporting, audit, and control experience.

The board intentionally distinguishes Harry's capital/cycle discipline from Calder's reporting/control/audit

discipline. Voss asks whether a course survives the cycle; Mercer asks whether it scales. Neither investor speaks as a constituency sovereign.

2023 — mature industrial governance

Margaret “Maggie” Kincaid joins with mining and heavy-industrial operating/governance experience. The appointment adds board leadership capable of integrating software, physical operations, capital, and accountability without converting the board into management.

2024 — independent Chair

Daniel voluntarily separates CEO and Chair. Kincaid becomes independent Chair. The separation is an act of institutional maturity, not founder defeat. Daniel retains founder conviction, strategic runway, and a director's full voice, while accepting that conviction is not sovereignty.

2025–2026 — committee architecture hardens

Audit & Compliance, Compensation & Human Capital, Governance & Nominating, Finance & Investment, and Technology & Operations become the five standing committees as AI/model risk, physical operations, acquisitions, capital intensity, J2, and enterprise-control complexity become materially greater.

The mature structure is not backdated. A future historical reconstruction must be able to show when each oversight practice actually became available, what the board then knew, and which authority owned each judgment.

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